

3. Eigenvectors, eigenvalues, Spectral theorem

② We know it holds: $A = T \Lambda T^{-1}$

✓ This implies that: $AT = T \Lambda T^{-1} T = T \Lambda \Rightarrow AT = T \Lambda$

From the matrix product, it holds:

$$AT = A \cdot \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ e^{(1)} & e^{(2)} & \dots & e^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ Ae^{(1)} & Ae^{(2)} & \dots & Ae^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix}$$

On the other hand

$$T \Lambda = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ e^{(1)} & e^{(2)} & \dots & e^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -\lambda^{(1)} \\ -\lambda^{(2)} \\ \vdots \\ -\lambda^{(n)} \end{bmatrix} = e^{(1)} \lambda^{(1)} + e^{(2)} \lambda^{(2)} + \dots + e^{(n)} \lambda^{(n)}$$

which is a sum of $n \times n$ matrices.

Let's expand the first of these matrices to understand its structure.

$$e^{(1)} \lambda^{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} e_1^{(1)} \\ e_2^{(1)} \\ \vdots \\ e_n^{(1)} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 \\ 0 & \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_1 e^{(1)} \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Therefore, summing the n matrices yields:

$$T \Lambda = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ \lambda_1 e^{(1)} & \lambda_2 e^{(2)} & \dots & \lambda_n e^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix}$$

If two matrices are equal, so are their columns. From this, it follows:

$$\begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ Ae^{(1)} & Ae^{(2)} & \dots & Ae^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ \lambda_1 e^{(1)} & \lambda_2 e^{(2)} & \dots & \lambda_n e^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{Therefore } Ae^{(i)} = \lambda_i e^{(i)}$$

③ We know $A = U \Lambda U^T$, which implies $AU = U \Lambda U^T U = U \Lambda$ because U is orthogonal and $U^T U = I$ for such matrices.

Therefore $AU = U \Lambda$. Following a similar demonstration as above:

$$AU = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ Au^{(1)} & Au^{(2)} & \dots & Au^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & & | \\ \lambda_1 u^{(1)} & \lambda_2 u^{(2)} & \dots & \lambda_n u^{(n)} \\ | & | & & | \end{bmatrix} = U \Lambda \quad \text{Therefore } Au^{(i)} = \lambda_i u^{(i)}$$

④ If A is PSD, it holds: $A^T = A$, $x^T A x \geq 0 \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}^n$

✓ Since A is symmetric, it can also be written as $A = U \Lambda U^T$

We can define $\Lambda^{1/2}$ such that $\Lambda^{1/2} \cdot \Lambda^{1/2} = \Lambda$. Since Λ is diagonal, so is $\Lambda^{1/2}$.

Therefore $\Lambda^{1/2}$ is also symmetric.

It follows:

$$x^T A x \geq 0 \Rightarrow x^T U \Lambda^{1/2} \Lambda^{1/2} U^T x \geq 0 \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

$$(\Lambda^{1/2} U^T x)^T (\Lambda^{1/2} U^T x) \geq 0$$

Let's call $\hat{x} = U^T x$. It follows $\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i \hat{x}_i^2 \geq 0 \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}^n$

which is satisfied for all x in $\mathbb{R}^n$ if and only if $\lambda_i \geq 0 \quad \forall i \in [1, n]$

Solutions show a different derivation, checking $(e^{(i)})^T A e^{(i)} \geq 0$